

Medical Emoji proposals

A 2026 filing plan, two Unicode process questions, and the history behind them



CT Scan and Blood Bag
planned
Pill Box retained as the
first alternate

Current filing plan



PLANNED

CT Scan

Strongest developed packet. Refresh 2020 evidence, confirm image ownership, and test the 18-pixel design against X-Ray and MRI.



PLANNED

Blood Bag

Complete evidence categories and a clear donation and transfusion use case. Refresh the evidence and test it beside IV Bag in black and white.



FIRST ALTERNATE

Pill Box

The clearest weekly medication option in the portfolio. Its usage signal is weak, so reviewers may still favor the existing Pill emoji.

Two questions for Microsoft

After submission, would Microsoft's Unicode representatives ask ESR to consider adding the proposals to an upcoming agenda through its normal review process?

Would Microsoft's standards team review the paper and, if it merits UTC discussion, help revise it for submission?

Full proposal portfolio

CURRENT PLAN



CT Scan
planned after revision



Blood Bag
planned after revision



Pill Box
first alternate

MORE EVIDENCE OR A STRONGER CASE NEEDED



Ultrasound
4 exhibits missing



Inhaler
Video + Trends missing



Pill Pack
Trends + overlap



Weight Scale
2 Trends missing



IV Bag
2 Trends missing



Maze
4 exhibits; 2 declines

LATER-CYCLE CANDIDATES



White Blood Cell
2 Trends missing



Leg Cast
comparators + design



First Aid Kit
4 exhibits missing

LATER-CYCLE CANDIDATES



Kidney
2022 decline



Stomach
2022 decline



Liver
2022 decline

The portfolio includes 15 concepts at different stages. The notes identify the work remaining before each could be considered for filing.

Why CT Scan and Blood Bag lead today



BEST DEVELOPED CASE

CT Scan

The machine and procedure support appointment, preparation, results, and care-sequence uses that X-Ray does not fully express.



STRONGEST TRANSFUSION CASE

Blood Bag

Donation, transfusion, blood supply, and patient-care uses are more specific than Drop of Blood.

Before filing

Evidence
Recapture the 2020 exhibits

Rights
State the ownership chain clearly

Design
Test the closest visual substitutes

Related concepts need direct comparison

Medication



Pill Box

Five evidence categories are present. The weekly organization and caregiver use are clearer, although Pill remains a strong substitute.



Pill Pack

Web Trends is missing, Image Trends uses the wrong comparator, and the 18-pixel image can resemble a keypad. Blister Pack may be the safer future name.

PILL BOX IS THE CURRENT ALTERNATE

Infusion



Blood Bag

Five evidence categories are present, and donation and transfusion supply a specific public meaning.



IV Bag

Both Trends exhibits are missing, and its black-and-white silhouette is difficult to distinguish from Blood Bag.

BLOOD BAG IS THE CURRENT FILING CHOICE

Additional candidates could move forward after evidence work



PROMISING

Ultrasound

The strongest recent Books signal in the portfolio, with broad clinical and personal uses. Four Google exhibits and an 18-pixel probe test remain.



PROMISING

Weight Scale

Broad medical and everyday uses, with a strong small-size image. Web and Image Trends remain outstanding.



WORTH ANOTHER LOOK

Inhaler

A distinct medication route with familiar carry, refill, and rescue uses. Video, Trends, and global recognition remain open questions.

Microsoft's review can help determine whether one of these should replace a planned filing. Each would first require the evidence and design work shown above.

Two Unicode routes serve different purposes

INDIVIDUAL EMOJI

CT Scan / Blood Bag

Revise before filing



Emoji Submission Form

Required 2026 route



ESR review

Unicode controls timing

Would Microsoft ask ESR to consider an upcoming agenda discussion through its normal review process?

TECHNICAL DISCUSSION

Revised discussion paper

Microsoft determines its position



Unicode document submission

If Microsoft chooses



L2 number if accepted

UTC may discuss or refer

Would Microsoft review the paper and, if it merits UTC discussion, help revise it for submission?

Apple, Anatomical Heart, and Lungs

9 accessibility emoji

Apple L2/18-080 | March 2018

Blind / Low Vision

Deaf / Hard of Hearing

Physical Motor

Hidden Disabilities

Apple presented a finite starting set and addressed Unicode's selection factors. It used the emoji-proposal process available in 2018.

2018

Apple accessibility proposal

Nine related concepts, organized as a finite set and argued under the selection factors used at that time.

2019

Anatomical Heart and Lungs

Christian Kamkoff, Shuhan He, and Melissa Thermidor submitted separate proposals. Unicode later encoded both characters.

2026

Current process

Emoji candidates use the official form. A separate discussion paper can raise a coverage and guidance question.

For 2026, the individual proposals and the discussion paper follow separate submission routes.

Questions for Microsoft

- 1 Are CT Scan and Blood Bag the right filing choices, or should Pill Box replace one?
- 2 Do the images remain clear at 18 pixels and in black and white?
- 3 After submission, would Microsoft ask ESR to consider an upcoming agenda discussion through its normal review process?
- 4 Would Microsoft review the discussion paper and, if it merits UTC discussion, help revise it for submission?

ATTACHED MATERIALS

- External review deck
- Proposal review brief
- Technical and rights questions
- Health-coverage discussion draft
- CT Scan working proposal
- Blood Bag working proposal
- Pill Box working proposal

Prepared independently by Shuhan He
Microsoft participation requires its own review
and approval.